

Our water strategy

Water is a local resource. For this reason, we have a context-based strategy that takes into account local conditions where we and our suppliers operate. We collect and analyze data and site-level feedback to understand our water impacts. We also gain insights into local watershed health — such as baseline water stress — using tools like the World Resources Institute (WRI) Aqueduct Water Risk Atlas.

We’ve identified that 70 percent of our corporate water use occurs in areas with high basin stress.⁵⁷ And we’ve found that the majority of our water-related impact is in the manufacturing supply chain.

We know that we can’t address water stewardship challenges alone. We believe we must go beyond our operations to collaborate with communities and work in basins on stewardship, replenishment, and WASH (water access, sanitation, and hygiene) projects throughout our value chain.

Low-water design

We approach low-water design by focusing first on site selection whenever possible and conducting a water risk evaluation to determine whether a potential site is in a water-stressed area. The results inform our decision-making and help mitigate the impact of our expected water use. We then design solutions to manage the quality of the wastewater that we return to the watershed.

Our low-water design efforts avoided 161 million gallons of freshwater use in 2024 in our corporate offices and data centers.⁵⁹ At our campus in Austin, Texas, we aim to achieve net-zero water use by relying on an onsite wastewater reuse system, as well as condensate recovery and stormwater capture, limiting potable water use to potable purposes only. This effort will save up to 60 million gallons of freshwater use annually.⁶⁰ Using wastewater for cooling will also allow us to achieve 28 million kilowatt-hours in energy savings annually at the location.

Our three most recent data centers have prioritized water efficiency by using high-efficiency air-cooled chillers instead of water-cooled systems, resulting in zero water use for cooling. At our newest data center in Waukee, Iowa, we’re also pursuing a 221-acre wetland restoration project on the property. The initiative will restore the land to native prairie potholes and wetlands, providing stormwater capture, groundwater recharge, and water quality benefits, as well as creating a habitat for native species.

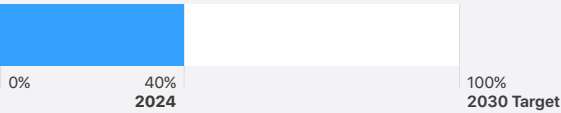
In our supply chain, the majority of water is used in manufacturing. We look for opportunities to innovate around water- and chemistry-intensive processes when possible. An example of this is a green anodizing project we initiated, which involved subject matter experts across internal design, product development, manufacturing, and quality teams, as well as an outside vendor piloting acid recovery equipment. The project integrated an acid recovery technology that separated and recycled two process chemistries — sulfuric and phosphoric acids — along with modular reverse osmosis systems that filtered water in the anodizing baths. The team worked to confirm that the approach functioned within both the tight process tolerances and the delicate chemistry required to maintain product quality. From 2020 to 2022, the collaboration facilitated this technology transfer — from early offline experiments and a proof of concept pilot to full production of a MacBook product.

The impact was profound, resulting in a 75 percent reduction in water usage and approximately 90 percent reduction in chemical use, which also helped achieve carbon savings.

Goal

Replenish all our corporate freshwater withdrawals in high-stress locations by 2030.

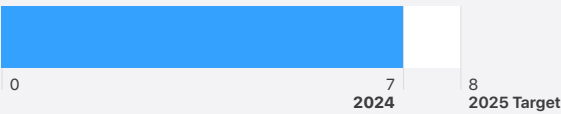
Progress



Goal

Certify all Apple-owned data centers to the Alliance for Water Stewardship (AWS) Standard by 2025.

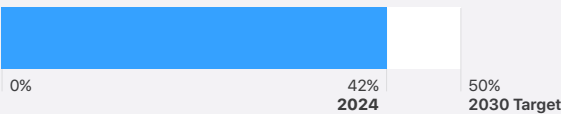
Progress



Goal

Increase supplier participation in the Supplier Clean Water Program, prioritizing locations with high water stress and supporting participants in achieving a 50 percent average water reuse rate by 2030.⁵⁶

Progress



We focus our work on five strategic pillars:



Low-water design

Minimizing water impacts in the design of products, Apple-managed services, and sites⁵⁸



Site efficiency and conservation

Improving the performance of existing sites and processes



Site water stewardship

Demonstrating responsibility beyond our facilities through watershed-level management



Replenishment and nature-based solutions

Improving water availability, quality, and access through regenerative approaches



Leadership and advocacy

Advancing water management through policy, advocacy, and technology innovation

To learn more, read our white paper, [Apple’s Water Strategy](#).